

A hospital administrator claims that her hospital operates as a meritocracy in regard to employee hiring and promotion. Which of the following observations would most support this administrator's claim? Employees are:

- ☐ A. promoted based on the amount of time they have worked at the hospital. [1%]
- ☐ B. hired based on referrals from individuals already employed by the hospital. [1%]
- ✓ ☒ C. promoted based on their demonstrated skills and accomplishments. [92%]
- ☐ D. hired based on the prestige of the training programs from which they graduated. [4%]

Correct

92% answered correctly

Explanation:

A **meritocracy** is a system in which **individuals** with the **most merit** (eg, talent, ability, effort) **progress** and **earn rewards**. In other words, factors such as prestige or social connections do not count in a meritocracy. While meritocracy is often considered an ideal, there are very few truly meritocratic systems.

The claim that a hospital operates as a meritocracy in regard to employee hiring and promotion is best supported by a system where employee promotions are based *entirely* on merit, such as demonstrated skills or accomplishments, rather than on nonmerit factors, such as seniority (ie, time employed by hospital) (**Choice A**).

(**Choice B**) Social capital includes the connections within one's social network that can help one advance, such as knowing individuals who already work at the hospital where one hopes to get a job. In a meritocratic system, employees would be hired based *purely* on merit, rather than on referrals from their social network.

(**Choice D**) Cultural capital describes all the nonfinancial and nonsocial network assets that confer advantage in society, such as the prestige of a medical training program from which one graduated. In a meritocratic system, employees would be hired or promoted based *purely* on merit, rather than on their cultural capital.

Educational objective:

A meritocracy is a system in which those individuals with the most merit (eg, talent, ability, effort) progress and earn rewards.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID: 401734

System:

Demographics and Social Structure

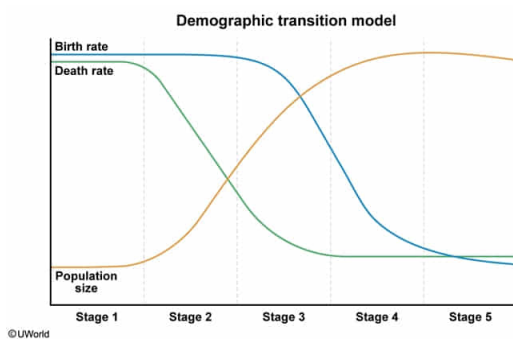
According to the demographic transition model, a newly industrializing society is characterized by which of the following?

- ☐ A. Low birth and death rates combined with slow population growth [10%]
- ✓ ☒ B. Decreasing death rates and increasing access to food, medicine, and improved sanitation [74%]
- ☐ C. Dropping birth rates and a declining population size [3%]
- ☐ D. High birth and death rates combined with slow population growth [11%]

Correct

74% answered correctly

Explanation:



According to the **demographic transition model**, a society's **transition** from **high birth** and **death rates** to **low birth** and **death rates** typically occurs in the following **stages**:

- Stage 1: In preindustrial societies, birth and death rates are both high and population growth is slow.
- Stage 2: As societies begin to industrialize, death rates drop as food/medicine availability and sanitation increase, and population growth is rapid.
- Stage 3: As societies urbanize, the population continues to grow, but birth rates begin to decline as access to contraception increases.
- Stage 4: In developed societies, birth and death rates are both low and population growth is slow.
- Stage 5: For highly developed societies with very low birth rates, the population may decline.

A newly industrializing society would be in Stage 2 of demographic transition, in which the death rate declines as a result of increased access to food, medicine, and improved sanitation.

(Choice A) Low birth and death rates combined with slow population growth characterize Stage 4 of demographic transition, which is associated with a *developed* (fully industrialized) society, not a newly industrializing society.

(Choice C) A society with a birth rate low enough for the population to begin to decline characterizes Stage 5 of demographic transition, which is indicative of a *highly developed* (fully industrialized) society, not a newly industrializing society.

(Choice D) High birth and death rates with slow population growth define Stage 1 of demographic transition, which is indicative of a *preindustrial* society, not a newly industrializing society.

Educational objective:

According to the demographic transition model, societies progress through stages marked by characteristic changes in birth/death rates and population size: high birth/death rates, small population (Stage 1); declining death rate, increasing population (Stage 2); declining birth rate, slower population growth (Stage 3); low birth/death rates, stable population (Stage 4); and very low birth rate, declining population (Stage 5).

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:401735

System:

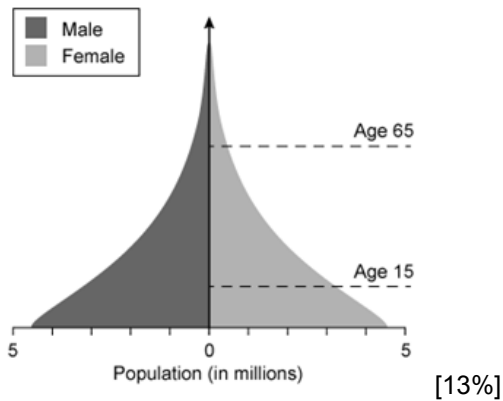
Demographics and Social Structure

Which of the following population pyramids depicts the population that is most likely to decrease in size in the near future?

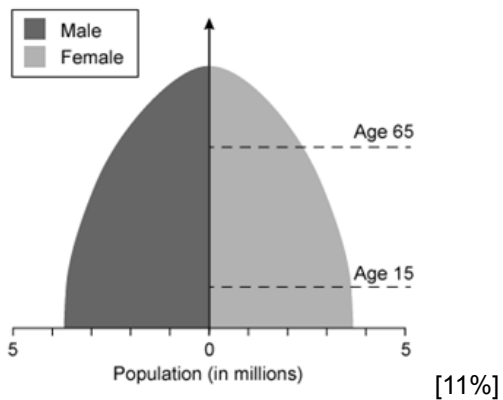
✓ ☒ A.



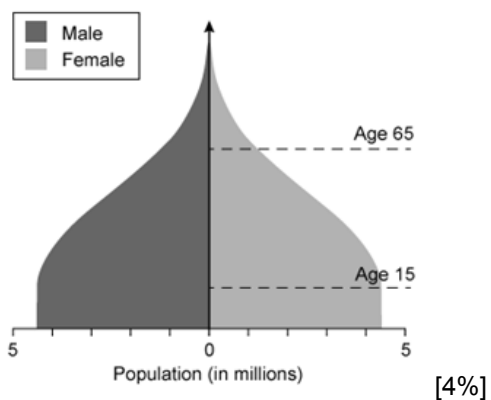
☐ B.



☐ C.

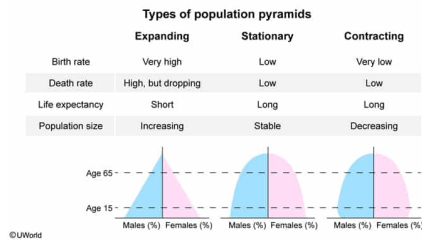


☐ D.



Correct

70% answered correctly

Explanation:

Population pyramids, which display the relative number of males and females in each age cohort in a given population, have three general shapes:

- **Expanding** pyramids have **broad bases** (lots of younger people) and **narrow tops** (few older people) and are characteristic of developing countries with high birth/death rates and an **increasing population** size.
- **Stationary** pyramids have **broad bases** and **broad tops** and are characteristic of developed countries with low birth/death rates and a **stable population** size.
- **Contracting** pyramids have **narrower bases** than middles and are characteristic of developed countries with very low birth rates and a gradually **declining population** size.

A contracting population pyramid reflects a population with fewer people in the younger age cohorts and more people in the older age cohorts (ie, base is narrower than upper levels of pyramid). In contracting populations, the number of individuals born will not replace the number of older individuals who die, resulting in an overall *decrease in population size*.

(Choice B) A pyramid with a broad base and narrow top depicts an expanding population that is growing in size.

(Choice C) A pyramid with a broad base and top depicts a stationary population that is relatively stable in size.

(Choice D) A pyramid that is between an expanding and stationary shape depicts a population that was expanding but is in the process of becoming stationary. In this type of population, the growth rate slows, but the overall size of the population does not decrease because more people live to old age.

Educational objective:

A population pyramid is a type of bar graph that depicts the number or percentage of men and women in certain age cohorts in a given population. Expanding pyramids reflect growing populations with more young than old individuals; stationary pyramids reflect stable populations; and contracting pyramids reflect gradually declining populations.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 401736

System:
Demographics and Social Structure